

CHAPTER 3 NUTRITION DURING PRE SCHOOL, SCHOOL AGE AND ADOLESCENCE

OBJECTIVES

At the end of this lesson, the student will be able to

- Understand the growth and development associated with the different phases of life like the preschool, school age and adolescence.
- Understand the different nutritional factors that may affect the growth and development during preschool, school age and adolescence.
- Understand the nutritional requirements and nutrition related problems during preschool, school age and adolescence.

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Parents look forward to being proud of strong, healthy, competent and happy sons and daughters. To grow and to function well in this adult world, children need a solid background of sound eating habits. Desirable food behaviors for a lifetime have their beginnings in childhood and adolescence. Nutrient needs change steadily throughout life into old age, depending on the rate of growth, gender, activities and many other factors.

3.1 Preschool Age

Early childhood is a stage in human development which includes toddlerhood (1-2 years) and preschool age(3-5 years). An infant grows rapidly, doubling its birth weight by 5 months and triples it by 1 year of age. During the second year, the child increases not only in height by 7-8 cm but also gains 4 times of its birth weight. After the age of one year a child's growth rate slows but the body continues to change dramatically. At age one, infants have just learned to stand and toddle; by two years they can take long strides with solid confidence and are learning to run, jump and climb.

Preschoolers are curious about everything that they see and hear. This is a great time for caregivers, both parents and teachers, to mold the children's minds and encourage them to use their creativity and imagination

3.1.1 Nutritional requirements of Preschool children

During this stage, children need vital nutrients for their brain to grow properly and the foundation for a healthy lifestyle should be laid during the preschool age.

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